

species are not to be counted towards this requirement. Landscape plans must include a planting schedule that lists all plant species proposed, the number of plants of each species proposed, and indicate whether each plant species proposed is listed in *Annexure B3-1*.

- (b) Three strata of vegetation are required to be included in landscape design, e.g. (i) tree or tall shrub canopy, (ii) mid-storey and (ii) groundcover layer.
- (c) All plants identified as priority weeds under the Biosecurity Act 2015, and those plants identified by Council as local environmental weeds on the property at the time of development are to be removed by a suitably qualified person.
- (d) Trees with hollows are to be retained for habitat wherever possible to provide habitat for arboreal fauna. Consideration must be given to the potential risk of damage to public or private property as determined by a suitably qualified arborist.
- (e) Sites that are undeveloped should be protected to encourage regeneration from the seed bank. *Sunshine Wattle* has a persistent soil seed bank which may last for up to 50 years (DECCW, 2007:8).
- (f) Council may require additional supporting information for an application including the following:
 - (ii) Vegetation management/protection plan; and
 - (iii) Flora or fauna impact assessment; and/or
 - (iv) An indication as to whether the proposed development is likely to significantly affect threatened species, populations, ecological communities or their habitat assessed in accordance with the *Biodiversity Conservation Act 2016*.
- (g) External illumination fixtures on land adjoining remnant vegetation must be directed downwards and away from reflective surfaces, avoid spill into parks, reserves and bushland and avoid shorter wavelength (blue-violet) light.
- (h) Remnant vegetation is to be protected. However, the removal of remnant vegetation may be authorized under other legislation including:
 - (i) Trees and vegetation are removed/trimmed in accordance with the *Roads Act 1993*;
 - (ii) The work needs to be carried out by Council, the State Emergency Services, the Rural Fire Service of NSW, or a public authority in response to an emergency;
 - (iii) Works are carried out by State or Federal Government Departments or Authorities under current legislative requirements; or
 - (iv) The tree or vegetation is a recognised noxious weed (*Biosecurity Act 2015*). The applicant must first seek advice from Council and Council must be notified in writing seven (7) days prior to the commencement of removal work.

3.3.2 Habitat Corridors and Recognised Habitat

Wildlife movement allows migration, dispersal, interbreeding and recolonisation of fauna species to occur, improving long-term viability of the species and local populations. Wildlife movement also facilitates plant pollen and seed dispersal, thus enhancing the viability of plant populations. Continuous Habitat Corridors are often preferable, but discontinuous 'stepping stone' corridors still contribute significantly to fauna movement and can be improved through habitat enhancement and plantings of local native species.